MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XIII Issue II Spring 2023



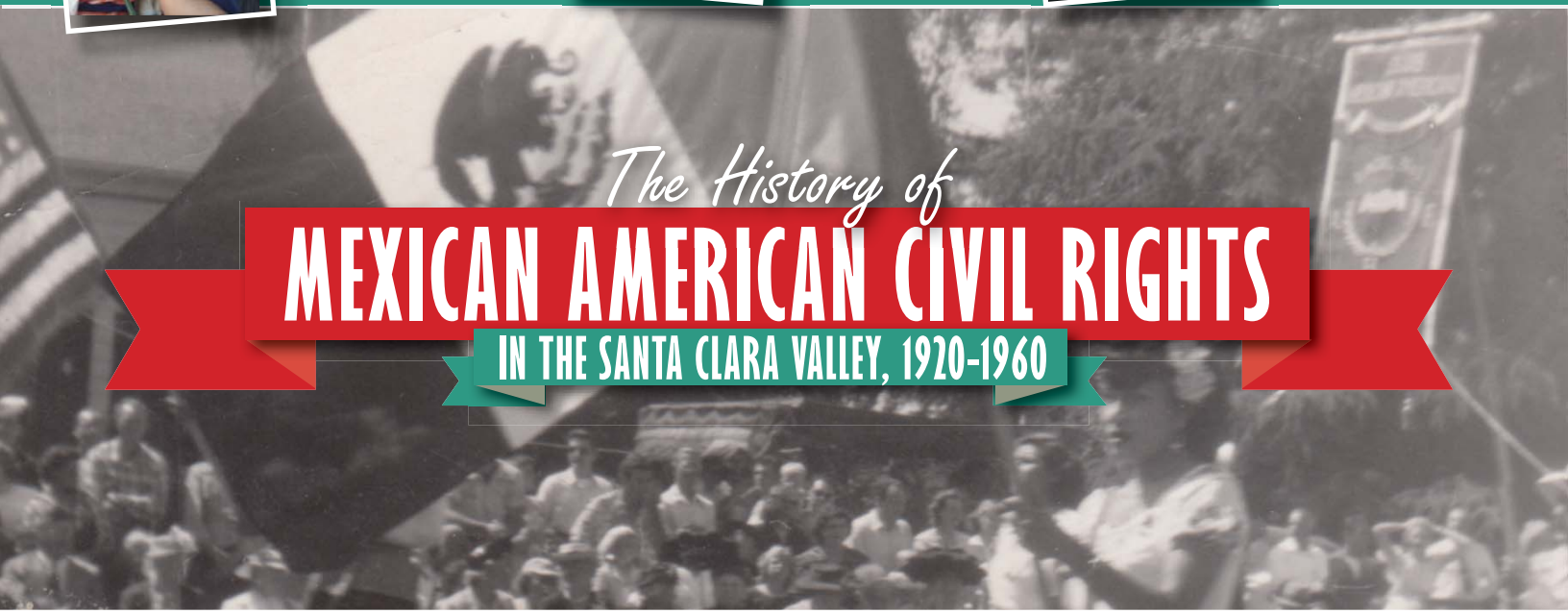
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A fond farewell to two fantastic MVHA board mmbers!



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Los Altos History Museum debuts new permanent exhibit



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Proposed revisions to our By-Laws



The History of MEXICAN AMERICAN CIVIL RIGHTS IN THE SANTA CLARA VALLEY, 1920-1960

Our Spring 2023 Membership Meeting & Event

For our spring event, the MVHA is pleased to partner with the *Before Silicon Valley* project, a San Jose State University Library initiative focused on chronicling the history of Mexican American cannery and agricultural workers in Santa Clara Valley from the 1920s through 1960s. The *Before Silicon Valley* team has invited Professor Gregorio Mora-Torres to join us on May 7 at the historic Adobe Building where he will share a talk on the history of Mexican American Civil Rights in Santa Clara Valley. This event is also being held in partnership with our friends at the Los Altos History Museum. In addition to Dr. Mora-Torres's talk, MVHA Past President Nick Perry will share a brief overview on the history of Mountain View's early 20th century Mexican-American neighborhoods: Castro City and the Washington-Jackson neighborhood. Light refreshments will be provided. We expect a good crowd for this one, so be sure to reserve your seat today on our Eventbrite page. We hope to see you there!

REGISTER ONLINE: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com



DR. GREGORIO MORA-TORRES, PH.D.

Our Featured Guest Speaker

Professor Gregorio Mora-Torres was born in Michoacan, Mexico, and raised in the Santa Clara Valley. As a youth, he and his siblings worked in agriculture—picking fruit and vegetables in the fields and later working in local canneries during high school and college. When Mora-Torres first went to college in 1972, his goal was to study civil engineering, but he soon discovered a greater talent for history. He graduated from Santa Clara University in 1976 and then went to the University of California, Irvine to pursue a MA and Ph.D. degrees in Latin American history, emphasizing Mexican history. In 1989, Dr. Mora-Torres started working as a lecturer at San Jose State University in the Mexican American Studies Department and stayed until his retirement in fall 2020. In addition to teaching, Dr. Mora-Torres has done extensive research and writing on Northern Mexico and Chicano history. He is now an Emeritus Faculty at San Jose State and a founding board member of the La Raza Historical Society of Santa Clara Valley.

Sunday, May 7, 2023 ● 1:30 to 3:30 p.m. ● The Historic Adobe Building 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View CA

News & Notes

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

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www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Pamela Baird

President's Message

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

Lights out!

The recent power outages in February and March are reminders that we live on a thin veneer of civilization. The electricity at our house was out for four hours in February and 36 hours in March. But many of our unfortunate neighbors had no power for five days!

We all scrambled to figure out how to preserve food, prepare meals, navigate in a dark house and stay warm. Candles, a kerosene lamp, flashlights and LED lanterns allowed us to eat a meal and get around the house.

This made me think about how different life was before homes had electricity. The city of Mountain View was electrified in 1902. The primary use of early electrification was to provide streetlights and lighting in the home. Old photos of Castro Street from 1906 show telephone poles and electric wiring. Progress!



Telephone poles line Castro Street c. 1906

Prior to electrification, lighting was done with gas lamps (many homes in large cities were wired for natural gas in the late 1890s). If natural gas was unavailable kerosene lamps were used for lighting. Kerosene, gasoline, wood, and coal were used as kitchen fuels for the large cumbersome looking metal cookstoves. It took skill to modulate these fuels so that food cooked properly. Refrigeration was done with an icebox (a large insulated box with a section for holding a block of ice which kept the contents cold). Electric refrigeration didn't become popular until the mid-1930s when Freon was used as a coolant.



1938 PG&E advertisement

Small electric appliances, such as toasters, irons and coffee pots, were introduced in the 1910s but widespread adoption didn't occur two decades later. Early large electric appliances like washing machines and dishwashers were expensive and didn't work well. A PG&E advertisement from the 1938 Mountain View Register Leader shows a woman using a wash board to do laundry. It reminded the reader how little electricity is needed to run your washing machine- go out and buy one!

When the power goes out we often think of not being able to use our computers, charge our cell phones or use lighting. But remember how different life was only 125 years ago prior to the electrification of Mountain View. And how lucky we are compared to the way our great grandparents lived.

—Pamela

MVHA Board Changes

By Nick Perry
MVHA Past President



Emily Ann Ramos

At a special meeting held on January 30, the Mountain View City Council voted to appoint Emily Ann Ramos to fill the seat vacated by Councilmember Sally Lieber due to her election to the California State Board of Equalization. Most who read this newsletter should recognize Councilmember Ramos's name; for the past seven years she's served as our organization's treasurer! And if you've attended any of our in-person events, chances are Emily's friendly smile greeted you at the check-in table. In March, Councilmember Ramos officially stepped down from her role as the MVHA Treasurer. In her resignation letter she shared the following statement:

> *I have enjoyed being on the board for the past seven years. I unexpectedly took over these duties from John Figueroa after the tragic loss of his wife and our former president, Pat Figueroa. As our board adjusted to the loss of many longtime board members, we worked on expansive programming highlighting the diverse history of our community and began to modernize our administrative systems. Serving on the MVHA board has been a wonderful way to learn and share the unique history of our city. As I take on my new adventure, I hope to continue elevating the history of our community so that we can all learn from our past as we build the future for the City of Mountain View.*

We hope you'll join us in saying a hearty THANK YOU to Emily for all she's done to help share Mountain View's history. We wish her all the best as she works to make a better future for Mountain View on the City Council!



Mary Kay Marinovich

The MVHA board also wants to express our deep gratitude to departing MVHA publicity committee chair, Mary Kay Marinovich. Mary Kay, or Marina as many of us know her, has decided to step down from her publicity duties to devote time to other commitments. Marina's enthusiasm for local history, creative can-do spirit, and positive energy has been a great asset to our board and she will be missed. The MVHA was proud to recognize Marina in 2022 by nominating her for a Santa Clara Valley Preservation Alliance Award for her tireless work and leadership in preserving Mountain View's Immigrant House and its relocation and restoration at Heritage Park. We look forward to seeing her at future Harvest History Festivals at Heritage Park!

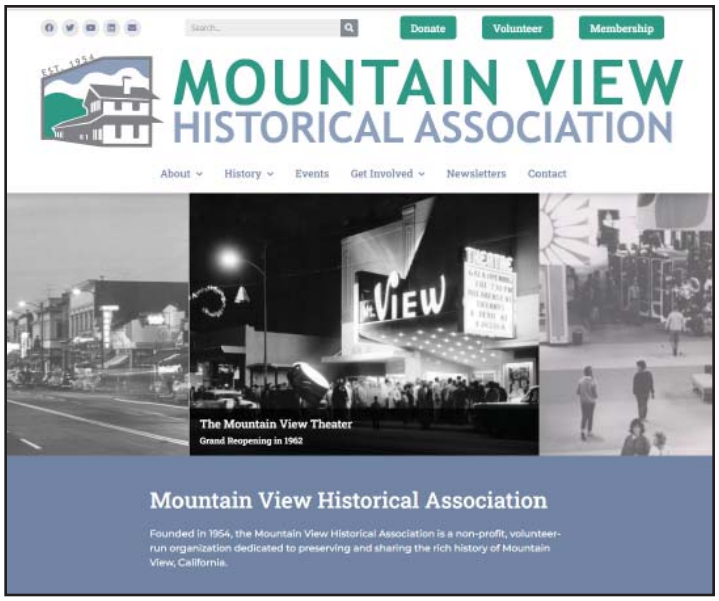
With the departure of Emily and Marina this past quarter, and Mark Perry and Candace Bowers the prior quarter, the MVHA Board is certainly experiencing a lot of change. Luckily, we have some great new volunteers waiting in the wings to fill the shoes of the wonderful volunteers that preceded them. But first, we need to make some changes to our by-laws. For more on that, see page 6.

MVHA Project Updates

By Nicholas Perry
MVHA Past President

The MVHA continues to work on a number of interesting projects, some of which have been shared in previous editions of this newsletter. Read on for some quick updates!

New MVHA Website. Have you been to our website lately? If so, you may have noticed it has a brand new look! After months of behind-the-scenes work with a local web designer, the site underwent its first major overhaul in five years. The previous design served us well, but we are very excited to have a refreshed page that brings the website up-to-date. The website now features an easier to navigate menu, updated graphics, and neat features/templates that will make it easier to showcase our historic photos and images. Take a look at the new site at: www.mountainviewhistorical.org and let us know what you think!



Screenshot of our new website's homepage.

Chinatown Interpretive Placard. The City of Mountain View continues to make progress on plans for an interpretive sign at the historic location of Mountain View's Chinatown, near the intersection of Villa and View streets in Downtown Mountain View. MVHA Board Members met with city staff to review a draft design of the interpretive sign. City staff are continuing to refine the design and review with key stakeholders.

MV Eagles Monument. Planning work continues slowly but surely on the creation of a historical monument at Eagle Park that celebrates the Mountain View High School Eagles and their historic 1975 football team championship. The committee working on the project has selected vendors to create the monument's signage and bronze eagle statue. Design work and coordination with the City of Mountain View continues to progress. For further information or if you are interested in donating to the monument campaign visit the 1975 CCS Championship Monument website: www.75ccschamps.com. Specific questions can be directed to Alberto Olmos at: bombero1@ymail.com.

Winter 2023 Highlights



Above: A look at the "Valley" section of the exhibit while its video wall displays an MVHA archival photo.



Above: Joe Perez spent part of his childhood as a migrant farmworker in Los Altos and grew up to become the first Mexican-American councilmember and mayor of Mountain View. The MVHA connected the museum with the Perez family and provided historic information and photos to help share his inspiring story in the new exhibit.

Los Altos History Museum Reopens

On February 11, our friends at the Los Altos History Museum celebrated the grand opening of their completely reimagined permanent exhibit on the history of our area. The MVHA was pleased to partner with the museum to provide photos and information related to the shared history of Mountain View and Los Altos. Prior to the exhibit's opening, the museum hosted MVHA board members and volunteers for a special preview of the new exhibit and we encourage all interested to visit soon!

Much of the exhibit consists of expansive video walls and interactive touch screens that allow curators to display and rotate a wide range of digital images, videos, and recordings that bring history to life in new and dynamic ways. Unique historical objects and artifacts are displayed as well. Instead of being organized chronologically, the exhibit is divided into four major thematic sections inspired by our local geography: the hills, the creeks, the valley, and the town of Los Altos itself.



Left: Shells from the Castro Shellmound, a large ancient earthen mound built by the local Ohlone people in what is now Mountain View, are one of many fascinating historical objects on display.

The exhibit is an exciting precedent for how we can share local history in new and dynamic ways, all within relatively small footprints thanks to modern technology like interactive touch screens. Although there are no active plans for a Mountain View history museum, the MVHA Board is inspired by what Los Altos has accomplished and plans to research opportunities to install similar interactive displays in places like the Mountain View History Center.



Stories of Heart's Delight

We had a great turnout at our winter event on February 5! Local author and historian Robin Chapman regaled us with fun and fascinating stories and images pulled from her research on the history of the Santa Clara Valley and featured in her new book, *The Valley of Heart's Delight: True Tales from Around the Bay*. Although the weather outside was cold and sometimes wet (Pretty much the story of winter 2022-23!) the historic Adobe Building was cozy thanks to the warm glow of its blazing fireplace and the friendly company of those inside. Thanks to everyone who joined us, we hope to see you at the Adobe again on May 7!



Left: Author and historian Robin Chapman at the MVHA's Winter 2023 event in the historic Adobe Building.

Finding Your Family History

By Robert Cox
MVHA Vice President

For those of us whose ancestors arrived in America since 1900, immigration records document the key events on their way to becoming American citizens. The most important immigration documents include naturalization records and passenger lists.

If you don't already have copies of these documents in your family archives, start by searching for information at www.familysearch.org for free. Census documents often include the country of birth and nationality of the person enumerated. Before World War I, many European countries were multi-ethnic. So, my mother's parents were born in Austria-Hungary, but were ethnic Slovaks. This is important because many of these multi-ethnic countries have since split up into multiple countries along ethnic lines. The records for my mother's ancestors are now in the archives of Slovakia.

Not all immigrants to the USA decided to become citizens. Some came to America just to improve their financial situation, and then return home. Some grew homesick and left. Others were satisfied just to earn a good living, and didn't want to go through the citizenship process, especially if they lacked English language skills. Others may have not arrived legally. So, you won't necessarily find naturalization documents for your immigrant ancestors. Furthermore, before 1922, most women were not naturalized independently. Their naturalization status was that of their husband.

When they do exist, naturalization documents can provide helpful information, like the person's place of birth and dates of immigration. For those who arrived by ship, the name of the ship and the ports of exit and entry of the voyage are usually included. Naturalization records are generally available at the local courthouse where the immigrant was naturalized or through the National Archives. If your ancestor arrived by ship, you can also request the ship's passenger list from the National Archives.

One surprising fact is that some of our native American (Indian) ancestors also have naturalization documents. This is because in the early USA, native Americans were considered citizens of their national tribe, and not of the USA. Just as upon becoming citizens, European citizens were required to renounce loyalty to their European monarchs, native Americans renounced loyalty to their local chiefs.

In my next column, I will write about birth, death, and marriage records.

Mtn. View Family History Fun Fact!

Ellen Kamei and her Three Kenzos



Ellen Kamei

Mountain View Council Member and Former Mayor Ellen Kamei's family history was highlighted by three notable Kenzos. Her grandfather Kenzo Kamei was born in Vacaville, CA. He met the love of his life Kikaso Nishimoto, while working at a flower nursery in Sunnyvale. Kenzo and Kikaso were later relocated to Japanese interment camp in Heart Mountain, WY, where they married. After World War II ended, they returned to the Bay Area, where Kenzo founded the Kamei Nursery in Mountain View. Part of the land on which the nursery was situated is now the location of the Mountain View street Kenzo Court. Most recently, Ellen became the mother of her son Kenzo, named after her grandfather. The name Kenzo is of Japanese origin and means "healthy" and "wise".



Kenzo Kamei (left) and his great grandson Kenzo (right), named in his honor.



Kenzo Court is a street on the site of the former Kamei family flower nursery

Special Feature
MVHA BY-LAWS REVISIONS

The MVHA is governed via by-laws that were last updated in May 2010. To bring the by-laws up to date, the Board of Directors proposes a variety of revisions for our members' approval. Per the current by-laws, members are being notified of the proposed changes. A track-changes copy of the by-laws is available on this and the next page of this newsletter. Proposed new text is in red underline; Deleted text is in red strike-through. Any member who wishes to vote on the proposed by-laws should attend our regularly scheduled Board of Directors Meeting on May 10, 2023 at 6:00 p.m. The meeting will be held virtually on Zoom. Members can log into the meeting using this URL: https://us06web.zoom.us/j/81353203227 or by calling via phone (audio only): (669) 444-9171 (Meeting ID: 813 5320 3227). Any questions or comments on the by-laws can be emailed to the Board of Directors in advance at info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

ARTICLE I – NAME
Section 1. The name of this organization shall be the MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION, known in official state and federal records as the MOUNTAIN VIEW PIONEER AND HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION.

ARTICLE II - MISSION
Section 1. The Mountain View Historical Association is a non-profit organization dedicated to preserving and sharing the history of Mountain View, California for the benefit of the community and future generations.

ARTICLE III – AIMS
Section 1. The aims of this Association are to:
• Gather and preserve historical data relative to the ~~early settlement and development of the~~ area in and around the present City of Mountain View;
~~• Collect, record, edit and publish a history of the development of this area;~~
• Record and share the history of this area with the community through publications and events;
• Recognize and p~~P~~reserve historic objects, and places, and sites;
• Cooperate with the City of Mountain View and other organizations in Santa Clara Valley on projects supported by our membership.

ARTICLE ~~III~~ IV – BOARD OF DIRECTORS
Section 1. The number of Directors shall be eleven (11).

ARTICLE ~~I~~V MEMBERSHIP
Section 1. All persons who signify their interest in the aims of this Association and pay the specified annual dues shall constitute the members of this Association.

Section 2. Individuals or members who express their deep interest in this Association by a gift of the specified amount or more shall be declared life members and be free of further dues payments for life.

Section 3. The Executive Committee shall review all categories of membership dues, submit for approval any proposed changes to the Board of Directors which may be changed subject to approval by a majority of the Board of Directors~~membership at the annual meeting~~.

Section 4. Honorary Membership shall be conferred upon an individual or business recommended by the Executive Committee and approved by the Board of Directors.

~~Section 5. Honored Membership has been conferred upon Miss Mercedes Castro (Sept. 1, 1870 – Apr. 30,1965), daughter of Crisanto Castro. Honored membership was bestowed in recognition of her family's contribution to our community.~~

ARTICLE VI – OFFICERS
Section 1: The officers of this Association shall be~~b a~~ President, Vice-President, Secretary and Treasurer.

ARTICLE VII – DUTIES OF OFFICERS
Section 1: The duties of officers shall be such as implied by their respective titles and as are specified in these By-Laws. Each officer shall keep accurate records of the work and turn them over to their~~his/her~~ successor.

Section 2. The President shall preside at all meetings of the Association, the Board of Directors and of the Executive Committee. ~~He/she~~They shall appoint Standing and Special committees' chairs subject to the ratification of the Board of Directors. The president shall be an ex-officio member of all committees, except the nominating committee.

Section 3. The Vice-President shall support the President in their role and perform the duties of the President in their~~his/her~~ absence. In case of the death or resignation of the President, the Vice-President shall become President for the remainder of the term.

Section 4. The Secretary shall keep a correct and permanent record of the proceedings of all meetings of the Association and the Board of Directors; shall keep copies of current Articles and Bylaws: shall keep a list of the names and address of all members; shall publish a list of all members annually for the historic record; shall, in case of the death or resignation of both the President and Vice-President, become the President until a President and Vice-President can be elected.

Section 5. The Treasurer shall receive all monies of the Association; keep an itemized account, in a permanent file, of all receipts and disbursements; present a written income and expense report on a quarterly basis to the ~~at meetings of the Executive Committee,~~ Board of Directors and annual basis to the general membership ~~meetings and for the Quarterly Newsletter,~~ and furnish all materials necessary for the audit committee. The treasurer will work with the secretary to file all necessary state and federal forms on or before the dates that these are due. The treasurer shall provide confirmation of the filings for the annual audit. The treasurer shall turn over to their~~his/her~~ successor, within ten days of vacating office, all books, records, papers and equipment including all data that is recorded on any electronic/digital medium accompanied by a hard copy of the same.

Section 6. If any officer~~,~~ or director or ~~standing~~ committee chair fails to attend three consecutive regularly scheduled meetings without adequate reason, such office or position may be declared vacant at the discretion of the Board of Directors.

Section 7. A Board member may be removed, with or without cause, by a two-thirds majority of the Board of Directors at a regularly scheduled or special meeting of the Board of Directors.

Section 8. Any member of the Board may resign at any time by giving written notice to the Board of Directors. Such resignation shall take effect at the date of receipt or at any later date specified.

CONT. ON PAGE 7

ARTICLE VIII – DIRECTORS~~STANDING COMMITTEES~~
~~Section 1. There shall be the following standing committees:~~
~~Historical Data Newsletter Ways & Means Membership~~

Section 1~~2~~. It shall be the duty of the HISTORICAL DATA DIRECTOR~~COMMITTEE~~ to cooperate with the Executive Committee in planning for the collection, recording, editing and publishing of historical data and in the program of preservation of historical objects and places.

Section 2~~3~~. It shall be the duty of the MEMBERSHIP DIRECTOR~~COMMITTEE~~ to suggest ways and means to increase the membership; to stimulate the interest of the membership in the Association program; to solicit membership and collect dues; to keep an accurate record of the membership .

Section 3~~4~~. It shall be the duty of the NEWSLETTER DIRECTOR ~~COMMITTEE~~ to gather, edit, publish and distribute quarterly newsletters with content relevant to the purposes of the Mountain View Historical Association.

~~Section 5. It shall be the duty of the WAYS AND MEANS COMMITTEE to formulate plans for the raising of funds for special projects of the Association.~~
Section 4. It shall be the duties of the three (3) DIRECTORS AT LARGE to assist the Board with serving a variety of functions based on their interests and skills, including special projects, publicity, outreach, etc.

ARTICLE IX~~VII~~ - DUTIES OF THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS AND THE EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE
Section. 1.
(a) The Board of Directors shall be composed of the four (4) elected officers, the immediate past president, the ~~four (4) chairs of standing committees, and two~~historical data, membership, and newsletter directors and the three (3~~2~~) directors at large appointed by a Board majority of five~~six~~ (5~~6~~) members.

(b) The Executive Committee shall be composed of the four (4) elected officers and the immediate past President.~~.~~

Section 2. The Board of Directors shall conduct the ordinary business of the Association; shall provide for at least four general membership meetings during the year and such other meetings as may seem necessary at the call of the President, or by five members of the Board of Directors; and shall ratify all appointments.

Section 3. The Executive Committee shall appoint an Auditing Committee annually by the end of the fiscal year (December 31.) The Auditing Committee shall be composed of three members of the Association and they shall submit a written report to the Board of Directors by March 31.

ARTICLE ~~I~~X – NOMINATIONS AND ELECTIONS
Section 1. Officers shall be elected biennially (even-numbered years) ~~in~~ at the annual meeting in November. They shall assume their duties immediately following the adjournment of the a~~A~~nnual m~~M~~eeting at which they are elected. Election shall be by majority vote of the general membership present at the meeting.

Section 2. At the August meeting in an election year, the President shall recommend a nominating committee for members' approval~~, which~~. The nominating committee shall present the nominees for each office to members at ~~to~~ the annual meeting ~~the nominees for each office~~. Nominations may also be made from the floor at the annual meeting.

Section 3. The President, with the approval of the Board, shall fill any vacancy occurring in one of the offices of the Association for the remainder of the term, except as provided in Article VII, Section 3 and 4.

ARTICLE XI – MEETINGS
Section 1. Regular membership meetings shall be held quarterly, in November, February, May and August, at a location decided upon by the Executive Committee. The regular November meeting of each year shall be designated the annual meeting. The date or time of a general membership meeting may be changed by majority~~a two-thirds (2/3)~~ vote of the Executive Committee.

Section 2. Dates and times of Board of Directors meetings for the upcoming calendar year shall be set by the President in consultation with the Executive Committee and Past President between the November membership meeting and the end of the calendar year. These dates shall be considered regularly scheduled meetings of the Board for the upcoming calendar year. Board of Directors meeting dates may be changed or cancelled by a majority vote of the Board of Directors. Special meetings of the Board of Directors may be called by the President or at any time upon request by at least three Board members provided that the date, time, and stated purpose of the meeting is shared with all Board members at least two days in advance.

ARTICLE XII – QUORUM
Section 1. Ten~~Thirty~~ (1~~3~~0) members shall constitute a quorum at any Association meeting. A majority of the members of the Board of Directors shall constitute a quorum of that body.

ARTICLE XIII – DUES
Section 1. The annual dues for members shall be as prescribed by the Board of Directors, payable for the current calendar year, in advance.

ARTICLE ~~XIII~~XIV– AMENDMENTS
Section 1. Amendments to the By-Laws may be made at any regular or special noticed membership meeting by a two-thirds (2/3) vote of the members present, provided such amendments have been proposed at the preceding meeting and notice given to each member at least ten days prior to the date of such meeting at which the amendments are voted.

Section 2. Notice shall be given personally, by electronic transmission by the association, or by mail or other means of written communication, addressed to the member at the address of such member appearing on the books of the association or given by the member to the association for purpose of notice.

ARTICLE X~~I~~V– PARLIAMENTARY PROCEDURE
Section 1. 'ROBERT'S RULES OF ORDER, REVISED' shall govern this Association in all cases to which they are applicable and insofar as they are not inconsistent with these By-Laws.

ARTICLE XVI – POLICY
Section 1. This Association shall be non-sectarian, non-profit and non-partisan.

End
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A c. 1960 MVHA meeting in the Adobe building. Perhaps the woman standing with paper in-hand is sharing an early version of our by-laws!

History Happening Now

Joan MacDonald Appointed to HRC

By IdaRose Sylvester
MVHA Membership Chair (Acting)



Joan MacDonald

Joan MacDonald, 93 years old, and a 63 year resident of the Monta Loma neighborhood of Mountain View, just joined the Mountain View Human Relations Commission (HRC). She is believed to be the oldest resident to take public appointed office in the city. As the chair of the HRC, and MVHA board member, I sat her down to discuss this historic moment

Question: *Joan, you've been continually involved in advocating for housing issues since 1960. You served as an elected trustee for 13 years on the Mountain View Whisman School District, and then 9 years as an elected trustee to the Mountain View Los Altos Union High School District board. You have walked precincts for candidates and measures in every election but one. You still serve on the board of CHAC, a local non-profit mental health agency, which you have done since its founding in 1973. You regularly attend council meetings, advisory body meetings, and community events, from protests, to musical concerts to support your favorite musicians. Others might choose to rest, why don't you?*

Answer: Age doesn't diminish need and capacity to help with positive projects and growth! I'm lucky I still have the bandwidth to add something meaningful to my endeavors. I guess because I was raised in a family that was community-minded and involved, it's in my DNA! I enjoy the fruits of my labor when something I've worked for or on comes to fruition. I cherish working on issues that can affect people of all walks of life and needs in our community.

Question: *Well, how did you choose the HRC to use some of that bandwidth? How did they get so lucky?*

Answer: I feel that HRC is the advisory body that reaches out directly to our community to work with everyone on critical issues. If you want to make an impact, you need to work directly in the community. I'm particularly hopeful that I can support work on mental health, which the HRC is currently doing. Today, the need for mental health services has never been as great and fortunately the stigma about those services has begun to diminish. Perhaps I can help with diminishing the stigma even more!

Question: *What advice do you have for other seniors who want to be involved?*

Answer: It's simple! Find a passion that you cherish and a way to nurture it, especially working with others. Seniors have a lifetime of experience that is invaluable!

Giants with MV Roots

By Pamela Baird
MVHA President

For maybe the first time ever, two members of a professional sports team have their roots here. Both veteran Brandon Crawford (January 21, 1987) and newly acquired Mitch Haniger (December 23, 1990) were born in Mountain View. As small boys both had dreams of someday playing for the SF Giants.



Brandon Crawford

Brandon Crawford lived with his family in Menlo Park as a small child. The family then moved to Pleasanton where he grew up. A skilled athlete at Foothill High School, he participated in three sports. He played baseball at UCLA. In 2008 he was drafted by the SF Giants and played in their minor leagues for three years.

Crawford made his major league debut on May 27, 2011. His first MLB hit was a grand slam home run, only the sixth MLB player to do so. Crawford is one of the premier shortstops playing today, having won the Golden Glove four times. Crawford is currently the longest tenured member of the Giants.

Mitch Haniger grew up with his family in Santa Clara, where he attended Archbishop Mitty High School. He was a two sport athlete. As a baseball player at Cal Poly, he was named an All-American in 2012.



Mitch Haniger

The Milwaukee Brewers selected Mitch in 2012 as an outfielder. He then spent the next two years on their minor league teams before being traded to the Arizona Diamondbacks in 2014. Haniger was called up to their major league team in 2016, before being traded to the Seattle Mariners. Over the past six years he has had several injuries, in spite of having his best career year in 2021. The Giants acquired Mitch in December 2022.

Go Giants!

Membership

By IdaRose Sylvester
MVHA Membership Chair (Acting)

A big thank you to all our members who have renewed for 2023. As you'll read elsewhere in this newsletter, the MVHA is in the middle of revising our by-laws. No changes to membership categories or dues are proposed.

Once the by-laws are revised, a number of folks serving on the Board plan to shift to new roles. So, by this time next quarter you should see the by-line of a new "Membership Director"in this space. Until then, please pardon our dust as we work through this transition period.

In other membership news: It's been great to see both new and long-time members step up and take on larger roles in the organization over the past few months. Thanks to their volunteer work, we've been able to take on new projects and initiatives which you'll all hear more about soon. Members truly are the lifeblood of any small non-profit like ours, and the more active members we have, the more we can accomplish in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View's history for future generations.

As always, thank you for your support!



It was great to see a mix of new and familiar faces at our winter event/meeting! A warm welcome to new members who joined us then!



Volunteer perk! MVHA Board Members and volunteers were given a special sneak-preview of the Los Altos History Museum's new permanent exhibit in early February.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! By becoming a member, you are making a special investment in our mission to preserve and share Mountain View history with the community, conserve priceless archival materials at the History Center, and hold memorable public events throughout the year. You can also join and renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.
Please support the MVHA, and join us today!

☐ New Membership

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Mtn. View, CA 94042

Thank you!

SPRING 2023

May 7
Sunday, 1:30 p.m. to 3:30 p.m.

Spring Event & Meeting
The Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View
More information on page 1

May 10 & June 14
Wednesday, 6:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m.

MVHA Board Meetings
Virtual Zoom Meeting
All interested members welcome to attend!
Email info@mountainviewhistorical.org for login.

April 23 & May 28
Sunday, 2:00 p.m. to 3:00 p.m.

Downtown Walking Tours
Centennial Plaza, 600 W. Evelyn Ave, Mtn. View
Details at: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com

Save the Date!

August 6
Sunday, Time TBD

Summer Ice Cream Social
The Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Blvd., Mtn. View
Details in our next newsletter!

Looking Back: Images from the Archive





Fr. Donald McDonnell

In anticipation of our May 7 event on the local history of Mexican-American civil rights, let's take a closer look at a photo that helps illustrate one of Mountain View's unique connections to this important topic. Here we see members of Mountain View's Mexican-American community gathered in the vestibule of Saint Joseph Catholic Church to sing "Las Mañanitas" in honor of the feast day of the Virgin of Guadalupe. The priest visible at center right is Father Donald McDonnell. When this photo was taken in the late 1940s, Fr. McDonnell was working closely with Mountain View's growing Mexican population. He helped community members, many of whom were working their way out of poverty, organize mutual aide societies like the Club Estrella (which celebrates its 75th anniversary this year) and the Guadalupe Federal Credit Union. In the early 1950s, Fr. McDonnell left Mountain View to serve the Mexican community of East San Jose, and helped establish Our Lady of Guadalupe Mission Chapel in 1953. There, he befriended Cesar Chavez and became an early mentor to the civil rights leader, introducing him to teachings on spirituality, labor rights, human rights, and social justice. The parish hall now bears McDonnell's name and the site was designated a National Historic Landmark in 2017.

EST. 1954

MOUNTAIN REVIEW

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
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Mountain View, CA 94042

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